

S.H.I.F.T.S.

1) **S**TARTING POINT -
SOMETHING I'D LOVE TO
DO AS WAY OF PLAYING MY
PART IS...

2) MY **H**OPES FOR WHAT I'D
LIKE TO HAPPEN IF THIS
WORKED OUT WELL ARE...

3) **I**N THE WAY OF THIS,
OBSTACLES OR DIFFICULTIES
INCLUDE...

4) **F**ACING ALL THAT, WHAT
HELPS ME IS...

5) A **T**URNING OR SHIFT
MIGHT HAPPEN IF I WERE
TO...

6) **S**PECIFIC ACHIEVABLE STEPS
I CAN TAKE IN THE NEXT SEVEN
DAYS TO MOVE THIS FORWARD
ARE...

“S.H.I.F.T.S.” is a 6 part storyboarding practice - with each of the letters (of S.H.I.F.T.S.) standing for a sentence starter. The invitation is to work through the sentence starters, in order, using them as prompts and seeing what words flow, for you, for each one. This process focuses our attention on the story that we are creating and can be a powerful tool in supporting us to take steps towards our hopes.

3 ways to Engage with this Practice:

Personal Practice

We can engage with the storyboard process individually, by writing down (or in some other way recording) our answers to each prompt. This has the added benefit that we can revisit our answers at a later point - if we feel to - for encouragement, clarity or motivation. Just see what naturally follows each sentence starter and don't be put off if some responses (particularly number 5, perhaps) don't come easily. Just see what comes - sometimes we can surprise ourselves, and it can be really valuable to give room to record any ideas that do just seem to pop up.

Paired Practice

If engaging with this practice with a partner, one person will go through all 6 parts of the storyboard process before you swap over. It works best this way as there's a momentum that can be built by moving through the sequence of the six parts, it is like telling a story.

It can help to briefly acknowledge the other person's response before swapping over (with, for example, a “thank you”, or “I hear you”, without feeling that we need to say more than that). If, as a listener, there is anything you'd like to share, best to wait till your partner has finished and then ask if they'd like to hear any comments you have. The role of the listener is particularly to show interest and provide a listening space. Just doing that can be such a valuable thing.

Before you begin, decide what time you have available, and how long you would like to set aside for each step, and agree on a gesture to signal to each other when this time has passed (remembering that this gesture means to complete whatever feels to be said, rather than to cut off mid-sentence).

Group Practice

If doing this in groups, it can work well to arrive and connect together as a group, then to break into pairs - to follow the paired process as laid out above - and then to come back to share reflections as a larger group, ensuring that everyone gets a chance to share something.

Background:

The SHIFTS Storyboarding Process fits within the fourth and final stage of the spiral of “the Work that Reconnects”, which is known as “Going Forth”. In this stage, we harvest the perspectives that we have gained by working through the previous 3 stages, and build on them to focus our attention afresh on a part that we would like to play in a more positive future.

In this stage of the spiral, it is valuable not only to give attention to our hopes (what we would like to be moving towards), but also to potential blocks to those hopes, and to resources that we could call on, or call in, in order to support us past those blocks. Setting intentions for specific steps that we could achieve within a certain time frame brings this process firmly into our daily lives, and it can be particularly useful to share these intentions with a buddy who can gently check-in with you about how they are proceeding. If you don’t manage to achieve them in that time frame, rather than giving yourself a hard time about it, this could be a moment to revisit this practice - focussing your attention on what has blocked you and exploring what might support you around these blocks.

The SHIFTS Storyboarding Process is a practice that can be revisited again and again - whether individually, or with a partner - to help us more consciously choose the stories that we are creating in different moments of our lives.

The SHIFTS process was developed by Chris Johnstone, and is described in more detail in his book ‘Seven Ways to Build Resilience’.

This process - and other resilience tools - can also be explored in a range of online courses (some of which are free!) at the website: <https://resiliencetraining.net>